Year 1 Admission Assessment v3.1: assessor instructions

Version 3.1, October 2026. Same content as version 1. Use with `Y01/Y01_Student_Booklet_v3.1`; do not mix versions.

Reusable: print once and keep in the assessor's folder. Do not write on these pages. Record each candidate's marks on their own **grading sheet** (`Y01_Grading_Sheet_v3.1`), reading on the **Reading front sheet** and the interview on the **Interview sheet**.

For a child joining **Year 1** (about 5 years old). Most have finished the middle year of a Chinese kindergarten (中班); some come from bilingual kindergartens. The visit takes **about 46 minutes, 1:1**, and should feel like play. The child uses the Year 1 student booklet; you write the maths marks in the mark boxes on the child's pages and record everything else on the child's grading sheet, Reading front sheet and Interview sheet.

1. At a glance

Order	Task	Minutes	Who leads	Materials	Student booklet	These instructions
1	Welcome	1	Assessor		page 1 (you write the child's name)	Section 2
2	Speaking: picture talk	4	Assessor		page 2	3.1
3	Listening: follow instructions (recording)	about 5	Assessor	crayons: red, blue, yellow, green	page 3	3.2
4	Reading: Early Reading Screen, then Graded Sentence Reading Screen	12	Assessor	shared cards, Early Reading Screen record sheets, Reading front sheet, levelled books, plain card	(separate cards)	3.3
5	Movement break	2	Assessor	water		Section 2
6	Maths	12	Assessor	20 counters	pages 4 to 11	Section 4
7	Writing	5	Assessor	pencil	pages 12 and 13	3.4
8	Play-based interview and goodbye	6	Interviewer (often the assessor)	crayons, Interviewer guide, Interview sheet	page 14	Section 5
	Total	**about 46** (44 minutes of tasks, plus the welcome and break)				

The order follows the blueprint for Years 1 to 3. These instructions put all the English tasks together in Section 3, so **writing (3.4) comes after maths on the day**.

What to print

For each candidate:

- Year 1 student booklet: A4, single-sided, in colour if possible (the pictures also work in greyscale)
- the grading sheet (`Y01/Y01_Grading_Sheet_v3.1`)
- the Reading front sheet (`forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`)
- the Interview sheet (`forms/Interview_Sheet_Y1_Y2`)
- the parent conversation record (`forms/Parent_Conversation_Record`)
- the final mark sheet (`forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`), completed after the visit
- the Early Reading Screen record sheets (`shared/Early_Reading_Screen_Record`): only the sheets you expect to use

For the room (print once, laminate the cards):

- these instructions
- the Interviewer guide (`forms/Interviewer_Guide_Y1_Y2`)
- the Sentence Reading Guide (`shared/Sentence_Reading_Guide`)
- the Graded Sentence Reading Screen card (`shared/Sentence_Reading_Card`)
- the Early Reading Screen cards (`shared/Early_Reading_Screen_Cards`) and guide (`shared/Early_Reading_Screen_Guide`)
- levelled reading books (`01_Reading_Books_and_Materials`)
- 20 counters, all the same colour and size (about 2 cm across), in a small pot
- 4 crayons (red, blue, yellow, green), 2 pencils, a rubber
- a plain card about A5 size (to cover pictures and sentences), a watch or timer

2. Before you start

The room. Use a low table. Sit beside the child at a corner of the table, not opposite. Keep the counters and crayons out of sight until each task needs them. A young child is never alone with one adult behind a closed door: keep the door open or have a second adult in the room. Show the child where the parent will wait. If the child will not separate, the parent may sit quietly at the back without helping; note it on the grading sheet.

Pace of speech. Year 1 students are still learning English: speak slowly and clearly, in short phrases, with a pause of about a second after each phrase. Use the same pace for every candidate, so that the results can be compared (do not slow down further for a child who finds it hard, and repeat an instruction only where these instructions allow it). The listening recording is paced the same way: a clear, steady voice with a pause of about a second after each phrase.

Welcome (1 minute). Say:

> "Hello! My name is [your name]. What's your name?" (wait) "Hello, [name]. How old are you?" (wait) "Today we are going to look at some pictures, play some games, count and draw. Some things are easy and some things are tricky. That's OK. Just try your best."

Write the child's name on the cover of the student booklet yourself (the child writes their name later, in the writing task). Note how the child first responds (English, Chinese, gesture, silence): it is early evidence for speaking and listening.

Access rules for Year 1

	English tasks: picture talk, listening, reading, writing	Maths
What you may say	Only the words in the script. Do not explain words, translate, point or show what to do. You may repeat an instruction once if the child asks or clearly did not hear: tick **R** on the grading sheet.	Any question, in English, as often as needed. You may point to the picture and show with counters.
Chinese	Not used by you.	If a Chinese-speaking colleague is present and the child cannot follow the English after you have read it aloud, the colleague may say the question once in Chinese. Mark the item **L** and list it on the grading sheet. The mark still counts.
Answers	English words, pointing and doing count. An answer in Chinese scores 0.	Pointing, fingers, counters and number words in English all count. An answer in Chinese scores 0.
Not yet taught		If the child or parent tells you the child has not met an idea, mark **NT**. It scores 0; list it on the grading sheet. Five year olds rarely say this themselves, so otherwise score 0 and add a note on the grading sheet.

Codes on the grading sheet: **R** instruction repeated once; **L** language support in maths; **NT** not yet taught. Extra time, a reader or extra breaks for a known need are allowed: record them on the grading sheet. Wherever these instructions say "note it", write the note in the comment space on the grading sheet.

Keeping the child at ease

- Praise effort, never correctness: "You are working hard!", "Thank you!", "Good listening!" Use the same warm tone after right and wrong answers. Never say "No" or "Wrong", and do not correct.
- A silent child is common: many young children new to English go through a silent period. Smile, wait, move on. Pointing tasks still work. Never pressure the child.
- If the child is tired, take a short extra break. If the child becomes upset, stop, comfort them and let them go to the parent. Try again later if they recover; otherwise end the visit and record what was done on the grading sheet.

Stopping rules

Task	Stop when
Picture talk	the child has not answered three prompts in a row. Finish with an easy "What's this?" so the child ends with success.
Listening	three items in a row score 0. Score the rest 0.
Reading screens	as the Early Reading Screen guide and the Sentence Reading Guide say.
Maths	three items in a row score 0 in Section A: go on to Section B, which starts easy again. Three in a row score 0 in Section B: stop.
Writing	the child says they cannot do more after one encouragement ("Have a go. Write the sounds you can hear.").

Movement break (about 2 minutes, after reading). Say: "Let's have a break! Stand up. Stretch up high. Touch your toes. Jump three times. Now sit down." Do the actions with the child. It is not scored. Offer water and the toilet.

3. English

3.1 Speaking: picture talk (4 minutes, student booklet page 2)

The picture shows a windy day in a park: the wind is blowing a girl's balloon away and she is sad because she cannot reach the string; a boy has thrown a ball and a dog is running after it; two ducks swim on a pond; the sun is out and leaves blow in the wind.

How. Open the booklet at page 2. Give the prompts in order, slowly and clearly (see **Pace of speech** in Section 2). Wait about 5 seconds after each one; if there is no answer, go on to the next prompt. You may repeat a prompt once.

Do not name things for the child or finish their sentences. Record what the child says on the grading sheet, as close to their words as you can ("dog run", "she sad balloon fly").

Step	Say	Listen for
1 Open	"Look at this picture. What can you see?"	Any naming: tree, balloon, girl, boy, dog, ball, duck, pond, sun, cloud, bird, flower
2 Naming	Point to each and ask "What's this?": the dog, the ball, the balloon, a duck	dog, ball, balloon, duck. Count how many the child names in English (out of 4) and record it
3 Action	Point to the dog. "What is the dog doing?"	running, chasing the ball, playing
4 Action	Point to the boy. "What is the boy doing?"	throwing the ball, playing with the dog
5 Feeling	Point to the girl. "How does she feel?"	sad, unhappy, crying, upset, cross
6 Explaining	"Why?"	her balloon is flying away; the wind blew it; she can't reach the string
7 Telling	"Tell me what is happening in the picture."	joined ideas: "The girl's balloon is flying away and the dog is running after the ball."
8 Predicting	"What do you think will happen next?"	the balloon will fly up to the clouds or get caught in the tree; the boy will try to catch it; her mum will buy a new one; the dog will catch the ball
9 Personal	"Do you like the park? What do you do at the park?"	talks about their own life

Speaking band at age 5 (examples from this picture)

Band	What it sounds like at age 5	Example
A New to English	Silent, nods or points; perhaps one or two English words; may speak in Chinese	points to the dog; "狗"; "dog"
B Early acquisition	Names several things in English; single words and two-word phrases; little description	"dog", "ball", "a duck", "balloon fly"
C Developing competence	Short sentences with a verb, often with errors; can say what someone is doing	"The dog is run." "She sad." "Boy throw the ball."
D Competent	Connected sentences; explains with "because"; tells the picture as a little story; errors do not get in the way	"She is sad because her balloon fly away." "Maybe the boy help her."
E Fluent	Talks as a fluent English-speaking 5 year old does: full sentences, words such as blowing, chasing, windy, reach, and ideas of their own	"The wind blew her balloon away and she can't reach the string. I think it will go up to the clouds, and her mummy will buy her a new one."

Give the speaking band from the picture talk on the grading sheet. The final speaking band is the best fit of the picture talk and the interview (Section 5), and is given on the Interview sheet.

What to look for

- A strong response needs few prompts, joins ideas (and, because, then) and predicts ("maybe", "I think"). A weak one needs every prompt and gives one word or repeats your question.
- Do not count against the child: missing -s, -ed, "a" and "the"; "he" and "she" mixed up; accent features (l and r, light final consonants). These are normal for learners.
- A child who names little in English but, as the parent describes, talks well in Chinese has an English barrier only. A child who says very little in either language may need a speech and language check: see the Interviewer guide and the Interview sheet.

3.2 Listening: follow instructions (about 5 minutes with the recording, page 3)

Recording. A recording of this test is in `audio/v3.1/Y01/` (see its `READ_ME_FIRST.txt` for the tracks and timings). Play it instead of reading the script: every candidate then hears the same voices, pace and pauses. The script below is its transcript, and the live reading option if no recording can be played. Do not pause the recording during a reading of the script.

Set up. Open the booklet at page 3 (the bedroom). Put the four crayons on the table: red, blue, yellow and green. Do not name the colours.

Say: "Let's play a listening game. Look at this picture. Listen carefully and do what I say. Ready?" Practice, not scored: "Put your finger on the picture." (Smile.) "Good!"

Rules

- Say each instruction **once**, slowly and clearly, with a pause after each phrase (see **Pace of speech** in Section 2). Look at the child, not at the picture: children follow your eyes. Do not point, nod or gesture.
- If the child asks, or clearly did not hear, you may say it once more: tick **R** on the grading sheet. A correct response after one repeat still scores.
- With the recording, if the child asks, or clearly did not hear, pause, go back to the start of the item (the start times are in the read-me) and play it once more: tick **R** on the grading sheet. Pause the recording while a child is still working on an item.
- For colouring, a small mark of the right colour on the right thing is enough. Say "Just a little bit of colour is fine" if the child starts colouring carefully.
- **Score 1** only when every part is right, and in the right order where the instruction says "then" or "before". Otherwise 0. No half marks.
- Stop after three 0s in a row.

No.	Say	Type	Correct response
1	"Point to the cat."	one step	the cat on the rug
2	"Point to the window."	one step	anywhere inside the window frame (the sun or cloud seen through it is fine)
3	"Point to the ball under the bed."	position: under	the ball under the bed, not the ball on the chair
4	"Point to the book next to the lamp."	position: next to	the book standing on the desk beside the lamp, not the books on the shelf
5	"Point to the toy between the car and the boat."	position: between	the toy duck on the top shelf
6	"Point to the teddy, then point to the shoes."	two steps	the teddy on the bed, then the shoes on the floor, in that order
7	"Colour the lamp yellow and colour the boat blue."	two steps	yellow on the lamp and blue on the boat (either order)
8	"Draw a circle round the clock, then colour the ball on the chair red."	two steps	a circle round the clock, then red on the ball on the chair (not the ball under the bed)
9	"Before you colour the car green, point to the bed."	sequence: before	points to the bed **first**, then colours the car green
10	"If there is a moon in the window, colour it yellow. If there is a sun in the window, draw a circle round it."	condition: if	draws a circle round the sun in the window and does not colour it (there is no moon)

Total: 10 marks (1 for each item).

Band guide (Year 1)

Score	0 to 2	3 to 4	5 to 6	7	8 to 10
Listening band	A	B	C	D	E

What to look for

- Items 1 and 2 need everyday nouns; 3 to 5 need the position words under, next to and between; 6 to 8 need the child to hold a longer piece of English in mind; 9 and 10 need grammar ("before", "if").
- Right object, wrong colour: score 0, but note it. Colour words may be the only gap.
- A child who does only the first part of every two-step item is probably holding too much new English at once, not showing a memory difficulty. A child who answers quickly and correctly but watches your face closely may be using your eyes as clues: keep looking at the child.

3.3 Reading: Early Reading Screen and Graded Sentence Reading Screen (12 minutes)

Use the Early Reading Screen (`shared/Early_Reading_Screen_Cards` and the record sheets in `shared/Early_Reading_Screen_Record`) starting at the letter sounds (Card 1, then Card 2 if 15 or more of Card 1 are right) and then the Section 1 words (Year 1 start point in the guide, Section 2); and the Graded Sentence Reading Screen (`shared/Sentence_Reading_Card`, with the rules in `shared/Sentence_Reading_Guide` and the score grid on the Reading front sheet) starting at Level 1.

The full scripts and rules for the Early Reading Screen are in `shared/Early_Reading_Screen_Guide`. Follow the scripts, scoring and stopping rules in that guide and in the Sentence Reading Guide; these instructions have no reading tasks of their own. All answers are in English, including the answers to the questions about what the child has just read. Many children starting Year 1 read very little English, and many fluent English speakers score 0 to 6 points on the sentence screen at this age, so stop kindly and praise the child's effort. Record the reading results on the **Reading front sheet** (the Early Reading Screen summary and the sentence reading results) and give it to the interviewer (Sections 5 and 6). Then take the movement break.

3.4 Writing (5 minutes, pages 12 and 13; given after maths)

Give the child a pencil. Do not spell any word, sound out, or write for the child.

Part 1: name (page 12). Point to the line next to "Name". Say: "Can you write your name here?" Record which script the child uses (English letters, pinyin or Chinese characters) on the grading sheet.

Part 2: five words (page 12). Say: "Now I will say some words. Write each word here. Listen to the sounds in the word. Have a go. It is fine if it is not right." For each word, point to the number, then say the word, the sentence and the word again, slowly and clearly (see **Pace of speech** in Section 2; do not stretch the sounds). Allow about 30 seconds; if nothing is written, say "That's fine. Next one."

No.	Say	Word	Spelling pattern
1	"sun. The sun is hot. sun."	sun	CVC
2	"fan. The fan goes round and round. fan."	fan	CVC
3	"pen. I can write with a pen. pen."	pen	CVC
4	"ship. The ship is on the sea. ship."	ship	digraph sh
5	"chop. Mum can chop the carrots. chop."	chop	digraph ch

None of the five words is on the reading cards, so the child has not just seen them written.

Part 3: a sentence about a picture (page 13). Point to the picture (a puppy in a box). Say: "Look at the picture. What can you see?" Let the child say it, and do not correct or improve their words. Then say: "Can you write about it? Write it here." If the child says they can't: "Have a go. Write the sounds you can hear." If the child writes one word, say once: "Can you write some more?" When they finish, say "Can you read it to me?" and write down what they say on the grading sheet: it helps you read their spelling.

Writing checklist. Record the name, handwriting and sentence checklist on the grading sheet, and for each of the five words whether it is correct, shows all the sounds ("fen", "shep", "chup"), some sounds ("sp", "c") or nothing.

Four criteria. Score each 0 to 4 (1 and 3 lie between the descriptions). Total: 16 marks.

Criterion	0	2	4
Content and organisation	Nothing written, or marks not linked to the picture	One or two words or a phrase about the picture ("dog box")	A complete idea about the picture, perhaps with a second idea ("The dog is in the box. He is happy.")
Vocabulary	No English words	Simple nouns (dog, box)	Words chosen for meaning: puppy, sitting, happy, big, peeping
Grammar and sentences	No phrase or sentence	A phrase, or a sentence with words missing ("dog in box")	A simple sentence with a verb ("The dog is in the box."); may join two ideas with "and"
Spelling and punctuation (the five words and the sentence)	Random letters, or letters not linked to sounds	Most dictated words show some sounds, usually the first and last ("sn", "fn"); one or two words correct	All or nearly all dictated words correct or with all sounds shown, including sh and ch; a capital letter or a full stop in the sentence

Writing band (best fit with the descriptors; the totals are only a guide)

Band	Writing at age 5	Typical total
A	Makes marks, copies, or writes their name only; may write in Chinese; dictated words not attempted or random letters	0 to 3
B	Some letters match sounds (often first sounds); one or two dictated words with most sounds; a word or label for the picture	4 to 7
C	Most dictated words show most sounds and some are correct; a phrase or short sentence that can be read with help	8 to 10
D	Most dictated words correct; a simple sentence that another adult can read, with spaces between words	11 to 13
E	Comparable to a fluent English-speaking 5 year old (below)	14 to 16

What band E looks like at age 5. The child writes their name correctly (capital letter, then lower case), writes all five words correctly or with one small slip ("chopp"), and writes one or two simple sentences about the picture that another adult can read, with spaces between the words and usually a capital letter and a full stop. Most letters are correctly formed. This matches the end-of-Reception expectation (the Early Learning Goal for writing) for a fluent English speaker.

Spelling from children who speak Chinese

- Pinyin letter values often appear: "x" for sh ("xip" for ship), "q" or "c" for ch ("qop" for chop). Count these as "all sounds shown" and note them on the grading sheet: the child hears every sound but needs the English letters taught.
- Vowel swaps (e and a: "pan" for pen; u and a: "san" for sun) and missing final sounds ("pe", "cho") are features of a learner's English.
- Many Chinese kindergartens are asked not to teach formal writing, pinyin or characters before primary school, so letter writing **may not have been taught**. A blank page is not, on its own, a sign of a learning difficulty.

What to look for

- Strong: hears every sound in the CVC words, uses sh and ch, writes a sentence without help.
- English barrier: forms letters well and spells by sound, but writes the sentence in Chinese or pinyin. The child knows how to write, but not yet what to write in English.
- Note pencil grip and letter formation separately: fine motor control is not English.

4. Maths (12 minutes, student booklet pages 4 to 11)

Content: the end of Reception (Early Years goals). **Section A: Number problems** (items 1 to 8, 8 marks). **Section B: Word problems and pictures** (items 9 to 15, 7 marks, with 3 word problems: 11, 12 and 15). Total 15 marks.

How

- Put the pot of 20 counters on the table. Say: "Now let's play some number games. You can use these counters to help you."
- Read each question as written, slowly and clearly (see **Pace of speech** in Section 2). Then you may repeat it in English as often as needed, point to the picture and show with counters. A Chinese-speaking colleague may say it once in Chinese (mark **L**).
- The child answers by pointing, saying, showing fingers or moving counters. Number words must be in English; a child who cannot yet say the number may show it with fingers or counters, or point to it.
- Write 1 or 0 in the mark box on the child's page as you go, and NT or L beside the box (list the NT and L items on the grading sheet). Do not say whether an answer is right.
- Stop as in Section 2: three 0s in a row in Section A, go to Section B; three in a row in Section B, stop.

Section A: Number problems

No.	Say and do	Answer, and what else is acceptable	Notes
1	Point to the fish. "How many fish? Count them."	**7** (said in English, or shown with fingers or counters). A number said in Chinese scores 0.	Watch: touches each fish once; says the last number as the answer.
2	Before you say anything, cover all three dot cards with the plain card. "I will show you some dots very quickly. Tell me how many. Don't count, just look." Slide the card to show only the first dot card for about 2 seconds, then cover it again. Do the same with the second and then the third (cover the cards you are not showing with the card or your hand).	**3, 5, 4**. 1 mark for all three.	Two seconds is too short to count one by one, so quick correct answers show the child sees the amount.
3	Point to the number cards. "Point to 9." "Point to 15." Point to 12: "What number is this?" Point to 20: "What number is this?"	**9, 15**, "twelve", "twenty". 1 mark for all four. 十二 and 二十 count (L).	Common slips: 6 for 9, 13 for 15, "twenty" for 12. Note them.
4	Point to the stars. "How many stars? You can put a counter on each star."	**16** (said in English, or shown with counters). A number said in Chinese scores 0.	Counting past 10 accurately; watch for missed or double-counted stars.
5	Point to the 8 dots. "Here are 8 dots." Point to the dashed circle. "One more dot comes here. How many dots now?" You may put a counter in the circle.	**9**. Counting all from 1 or knowing straight away both score; note which.	"9!" straight away shows stronger number sense than counting from 1.
6	Point to the five frame. "This box has space for 5 dots. Here are 3 dots. How many more dots make 5?"	**2**. Pointing to the 2 empty squares and saying 2, or putting 2 counters in, scores.	Five frames may not have been taught.
7	Point to the ladybird. "This ladybird has 4 spots on this side (point) and 4 spots on this side (point). Double 4. How many spots altogether?"	**8**. Counting all scores.	The words "double" and "altogether" may not have been taught; the picture carries the meaning.
8	Point to the ten frame. "This box has space for 10 dots. Here are 7 dots. How many more dots make 10?"	**3**. Counters in the empty squares and counting score.	Number bonds to 10 may not have been taught.

Section B: Word problems and pictures (WP = word problem)

No.	Say and do	Answer, and what else is acceptable	Notes
9	Point to the pencils. "Point to the longer pencil." Point to the ribbons. "Point to the shorter ribbon."	The **bottom pencil**, then the **top ribbon**. 1 mark for both.	The longer pencil and the shorter ribbon are in different rows, so a child who always points to the same row will not score by chance.
10	"Point to the circle." "Point to the triangle." Point to the square: "What is this shape called?"	**circle, triangle**, "square". 1 mark for all three. 正方形 counts (L).	"Rectangle" for the square scores 0; note it.
11 WP	Point to the girl: "This is Mei." Point to the boy: "This is Jun." "Mei has 4 dumplings. Jun has 7 dumplings. Who has more dumplings?" (wait) "Who has fewer dumplings?"	**Jun**, then **Mei** (pointing to the child or the plate is fine). 1 mark for both.	If the child does not respond to "fewer", you may also ask "Who has less?"; note it.
12 WP	Point to the pond. "There are 7 ducks on the pond. 1 duck swims away. How many ducks are on the pond now?" The child may cover a duck with a finger or a counter.	**6**.	One less, in a story.
13	Point to the tree. "Point to the rabbit behind the tree." (wait) "Point to the rabbit in front of the tree."	**Behind**: the rabbit peeping out from behind the trunk (only its head, ears and a paw show). **In front**: the rabbit sitting against the bottom of the trunk. 1 mark for both.	The rabbit on the left is next to the tree: it is the other choice. Position words are taught in Chinese (前面, 后面, 旁边), so the English may be the only gap.
14	Run your finger along the row without naming the fruit. "Look at this pattern." Point to the question mark. "What comes next?" Point to the three pictures below: "This, this or this?"	**banana** (pointing to it, or saying "banana" or 香蕉, L).	Do not say the fruit names aloud: the sound of the pattern gives the answer away.
15 WP	Put 8 counters by the plates. "These are 8 biscuits. Mum puts them on 2 plates. Each plate has the same. How many biscuits are on each plate?"	**4**, with 4 counters on each plate. If the child shares correctly but does not say a number, ask "How many on this plate?" and accept the answer.	Watch the method: dealing one at a time, or guessing and fixing.

Band guide (provisional; review after the first 20 to 30 candidates)

Total	0 to 5	6 to 8	9 to 12	13 to 15
Band	1 Well below expected	2 Working towards	3 Expected	4 Greater depth

Number problems and word problems. Items 11, 12 and 15 use the same number ideas as Section A, but in English sentences. A child who does well on the number problems but poorly on the word problems may have an **English barrier rather than a maths difficulty**: check by reading the word problem aloud again, showing it with counters, and, if a Chinese-speaking colleague is present, having it said once in Chinese (mark L). Record the result on the grading sheet.

Likely not yet taught

Chinese kindergartens are asked not to teach primary school content (the policy known as 去小学化), so what a child knows varies a lot; many children also go to extra classes. Ask the parent. A child who has finished the middle year (中班):

Item	May not have been taught
2	Quick recognition of dot patterns as a game, although dice are familiar
3, 4	Reading teen numbers; many kindergartens count to 20 aloud but read numerals only to 10
6, 8	Five and ten frames, and number bonds (数的分成, splitting 5 or 10 into two parts), which are usually taught in the top year (大班)
7	"Double" as a named idea
11	The English word "fewer" ("more" is usually known)
13	The English position words (the ideas are usually known in Chinese)
14	The English words "pattern" and "comes next" (repeating patterns, 找规律, are often met in kindergarten)
15	Sharing equally (平均分) as a named idea

What to look for

- How the child counts: touching each object, counting on from a number, or knowing at a glance. Confidence with numbers beyond 10.
- An English barrier looks like this: the child is lost at first, then answers quickly once you show it with counters or a colleague says it in Chinese. A maths difficulty looks like this: the child cannot do it even when the meaning is clear (for example, cannot count 7 objects reliably).
- Strong children often answer before you finish the question and use counters only to check.

5. Play-based interview and goodbye (6 minutes, page 14)

The questions are in `forms/Interviewer_Guide_Y1_Y2` and the record is the Interview sheet (`forms/Interview_Sheet_Y1_Y2`). Sit on the floor or at the low table, open the student booklet at page 14 (Draw) and offer the crayons: the interview starts with a drawing ("Can you draw you, doing something you love?"). Play alongside, talk about the drawing and follow the child's lead. Give the speaking band on the Interview sheet, combining the interview with the picture talk (recorded on the grading sheet). The observation boxes on the Interview sheet cover the whole visit, so fill them in now.

Goodbye. Say: "Thank you, [name]! You worked really hard today. I liked [something specific, such as your drawing or your counting]. Let's go and find Mum (or Dad)." Do not give any results to the family on the day.

6. Recording the results

1. Mark the student booklet the same day (every maths question has a mark box).
2. Copy the totals onto the grading sheet and give the bands from the band guides above (the grading sheet repeats them at a glance).
3. Record the reading results and band on the Reading front sheet (the reading band comes from the Early Reading Screen, guide section 6.7).
4. Give the interviewer the Reading front sheet and the Interview sheet before the interview.
5. After the interview, put together the grading sheet, Reading front sheet, Interview sheet and parent conversation record, and complete the final mark sheet (`forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`) within two working days.
6. File the marked student booklet with them (or shred it under the school's policy).